

The animal kingdom

The animal kingdom is divided into vertebrates and invertebrates. Mammals, birds, reptiles, amphibians, and fish are vertebrates. Insects are a type of invertebrate.



Animals

All animals, including people, have one thing in common – they eat other living things, either plants, or animals, or both. Almost all, except a few sea creatures, can move around.



The beetle has muscles attached to its skeleton just like you do. Its skeleton is on the outside, however, while yours is on the inside.

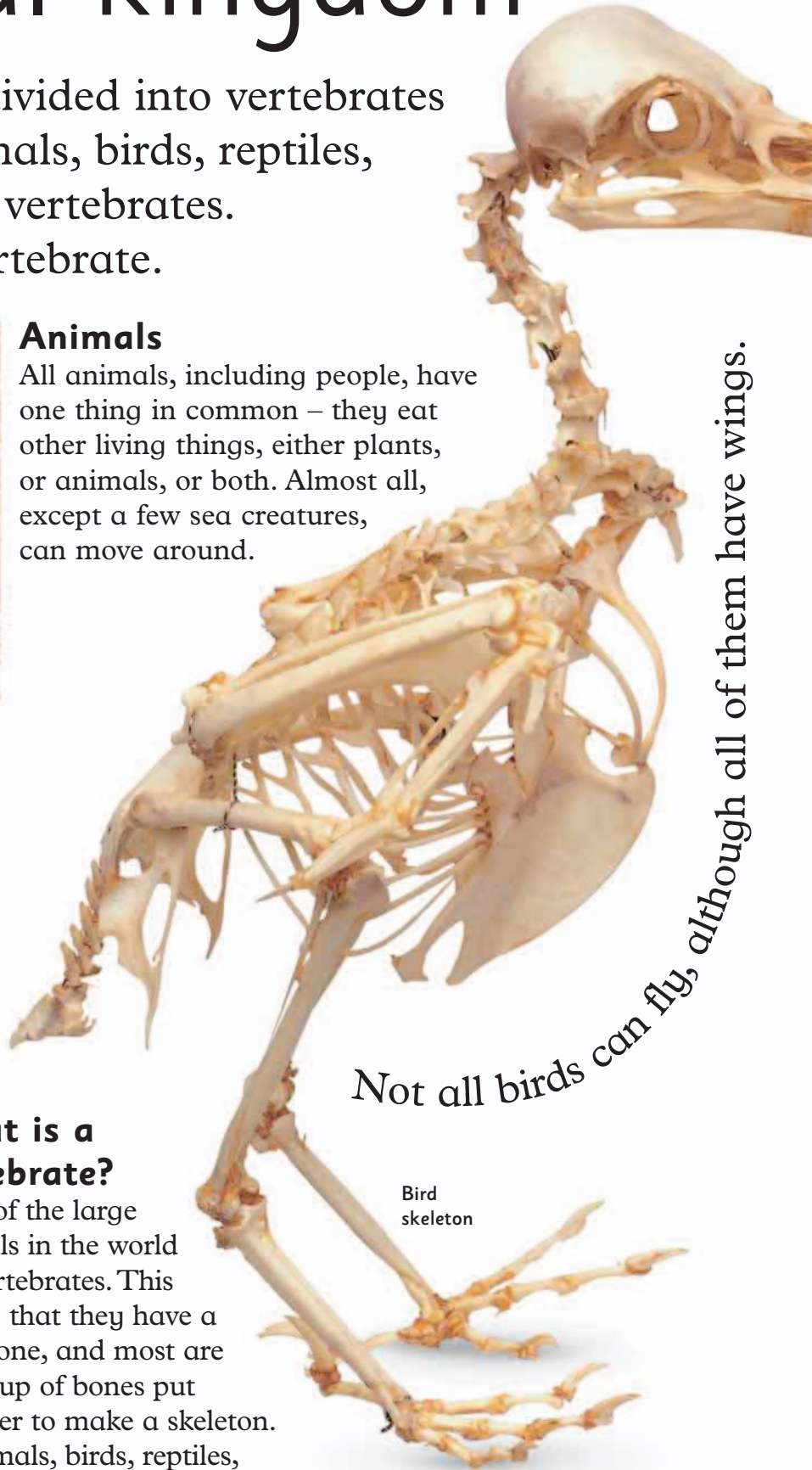
Beetle skeleton

What is an invertebrate?

The word invertebrate simply means not having a backbone. The “creepy-crawly” section of this book deals with the animals called invertebrates. Some of them have skeletons on the outside of their bodies, while some don’t have any bones at all.

What is a vertebrate?

Most of the large animals in the world are vertebrates. This means that they have a backbone, and most are made up of bones put together to make a skeleton. Mammals, birds, reptiles, amphibians, and fish are all vertebrates.



Not all birds can fly, although all of them have wings.

Bird skeleton